

1967–1970

MENSWEAR GOES POP

Movers and shakers from the pop charts took the fashion world by storm in the 1960s. Designers used famous faces and fleeting fads to influence and inspire their clothing collections, with the result that music and menswear went hand in hand. Top of the pops was British band The Beatles, the ultimate mods of music. Their revolutionary style, including longer hair and matching suits, was reflected in the fashions adopted enthusiastically by young men on both sides of the Atlantic. Clothing lines grew at the same rapid rate as fan bases. Continental creations favoured by well-known actors and models were also manufactured for the mass market. The admiration and adulation that greeted the arrival of new style icons on the music scene, including the Rolling Stones, The Who, and The Animals, was unprecedented. More and more high-street boutiques opened up, encouraging young men to splash their hard-earned cash on replica clothing that paid homage to their heroes.



Beatlemania The impact of Liverpoolian pop group The Beatles was huge. The “Fab Four” dominated the music charts and, as Beatlemania took hold, their fashion choices influenced a generation.

KING OF CARNABY STREET



In 1957 John Stephen (1934–2004) arrived in London from Glasgow and started work as an assistant in Carnaby Street's Vince boutique, the first men's clothing store to open in this trendy area. Here, he was inspired to build on the growing demand for modern menswear and also unisex styles, which resulted in his chain of influential shops opening across the capital. Stephen is seen here (second right) posing with models on his beloved Carnaby Street.



Fontenoy's flares A low waist and flared legs were popular developments in men's trousers at the end of the 1960s. This on-trend pair made of synthetic jersey was produced by French fashion house Fontenoy.

Velvet cords This cotton velvet corduroy suit is made from a furnishing fabric produced by the American manufacturer Hexter. Lined with silk, it pairs a double-breasted jacket with hipster trousers.